

Key Takeaways from 1Q25 Briefing

Following the [guidance pause](#), mgmt provided more details around potential tariff impact at the briefing. Mgmt thinks tariffs are more of a headwind to growth rather than a major asset quality risk (inline with [our view](#)). Hedging and trade front loading could still support activities in early part of 2Q, but visibility is low after that. UOB remains committed to existing capital return policy.

Impact of Tariff. Overall mgmt stays positive on ASEAN's long term outlook, and sees tariffs as a near term headwind to growth rather than a major asset quality risk. The initial assessment suggests the first order impact is manageable. Trade loan overall is 10% of group loans, and SME are another 10%. Only 2% of loan book is to customers with >10% export to US. 80% of the trade UOB services are intra-Asia. The second order impacts however are harder to predict, hence resulted in the guidance suspension. While uncertainty prevails, the bank noted heightened hedging needs from clients, and some businesses front loading shipments and activities in Apr to get things done within the 90d tariff pause window, meaning the slowdown in growth could be felt more towards late 2Q or even 2H25.

14% ROE? The 14% ROE target by 2026 is subject to macro condition, which is far from favorable right now. Mgmt believes the bank's business model is designed to deliver 14% ROE over the next 2-3 years, on the back of diverse geographical exposures in some high return markets, growing non-IL business and low-40% CIR.

Capital Return. Despite the guidance pause, UOB reaffirmed the S\$3bn capital return package and its 50% payout ratio policy. The bank has no intention to withhold surplus capital in the long term and is open to return to shareholder if there is no better growth opportunity to deploy for. Mgmt reviews its capital plan regularly and proactively to ensure the bank operates in a capital efficient manner. That said, given the tariff situation right now, it is difficult to make a well-informed decision on what is the capital need for growth until there is better macro clarity.

NIM Sensitivity. 1Q25 NIM was stable QoQ at 2.00%. Exit NIM was slightly lower at 1.98%. NIM sensitivity is lowered to 1.2bps for each 25bps rate cut (vs. previously 1.6bps). Mgmt believes the bank still has some room to manage its NIM mainly with tighter control on liability costs.

Wealth Mgmt. Wealth mgmt income registered strong growth in 1Q25, +30% YoY. Mgmt noted elevated market volatility in Apr and said it was too early to conclude direction. Some clients are turning more conservative, and switching from equity to fixed income or money market products where margin could be lower. Net new money in 1Q was seasonally weaker due to holiday, and offset by market value change leading to 0.5% decline in retail AUM QoQ.

Asset quality. New NPA of S\$400mn this quarter is within earlier guidance. One of the drivers was a HK property loan, which is now adequately provided. The GP increase this quarter was preemptive, and the amount (S\$133mn) is a function of robust PPOP trend allowing the bank to push the CoR to high end of 30-35bps range. The bank has not changed its ECL1 assumption for now. In light of the macro uncertainty, UOB could increase its GP/performing loan ratio from currently ~80bps to ~90bps. Overall mgmt believes the tariff impact is less than Covid on the asset quality front.

FLASH NOTE

RATING	BUY
PRICE	SGD34.43 ^a
PRICE TARGET % TO PT	SGD43.00 +25%
52W HIGH-LOW	SGD39.20 - SGD29.00
FLOAT (%) ADV MM (USD)	75.0% 119.47
MARKET CAP	SGD57.6B \$44.6B
TICKER	UOB SP

^aPrior trading day's closing price unless otherwise noted.

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United Overseas Bank Ltd.

United Overseas Bank Ltd. provides a wide range of financial services. The company operates a global network of branches, offices, subsidiaries and associates. It is engaged in the business of providing personal financial services, private banking, commercial and corporate banking, investment banking, corporate finance, capital market activities, treasury services, futures broking, asset management, venture capital management, insurance and stock broking services. UOB also has diversified interests in travel and property management. It also offers loans to small and medium enterprises. The company operates through the following major banking subsidiaries: Far Eastern Bank, United Overseas Bank (Malaysia), United Overseas Bank (Thai), PT Bank UOB Buana and United Overseas Bank (China). It has operations in Asia Pacific, Western Europe and North America. The company was founded by Wee Kheng Chiang on August 6, 1935, and is headquartered in Singapore.

Company Valuation/Risks

United Overseas Bank Ltd.

Our PT of S\$43 is based on a 11.5x multiple applied to 12m fwd EPS. Key upside risks include better-than-expected loan growth, margins and asset quality. Key downside risks include sudden reversal of liquidity, wider credit spreads, risk premium, and trade frictions.

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(Article 3(1)e and Article 7 of MAR)

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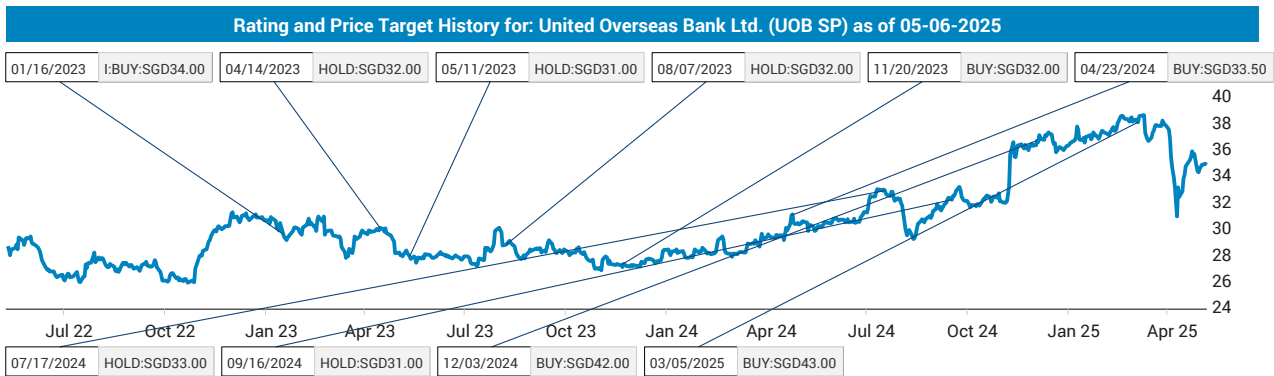
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